

Verb + Preposition Reference

Dependent Prepositions — Comprehensive Table

Many English verbs are always followed by a specific preposition. There are no rules — these combinations must be learned as fixed pairs. The table below lists the most common verb + preposition combinations, with three example sentences for each preposition. Examples mix nouns, noun phrases, and verb-ing forms, since any of these can follow a preposition.

Preposition	Main verbs	Examples
for	apply for, wait for, pay for, apologise for, search for, ask for, look for, prepare for, hope for, thank (someone) for, blame (someone) for, care for.	1. She paid for dinner . 2. We applied for the new position . 3. He apologised for arriving late .
to	belong to, respond to, refer to, object to, look forward to, contribute to, listen to, reply to, react to, lead to, talk to, explain (something) to (someone).	1. This bag belongs to Sarah . 2. She responded to my email . 3. We look forward to meeting you .
about	think about, talk about, worry about, complain about, dream about, forget about, ask about, hear about, know about, argue about, read about, learn about.	1. They talked about politics . 2. He worries about his health . 3. She dreams about travelling the world .
on	depend on, rely on, concentrate on, insist on, spend (time/money) on, congratulate (someone) on, decide on, focus on, count on, comment on, agree on, work on.	1. We rely on technology . 2. The plan depends on the weather . 3. She insisted on paying the bill .
in	believe in, succeed in, participate in, result in, specialise in, invest in, engage in, take part in, confide in, persist in.	1. He believes in love . 2. The company invests in new technology . 3. She succeeded in passing the exam .
from	suffer from, recover from, benefit from, prevent (someone) from, differ from, escape from, retire from, resign from, protect (someone) from, refrain from, hear from, borrow from.	1. He suffers from asthma . 2. She recovered from a serious illness . 3. The law prevents companies from polluting rivers .
with	agree with (someone), deal with, cope with, argue with, provide (someone) with, compare with, struggle with, sympathise with, cooperate with, interfere with.	1. I agree with Maria . 2. She is struggling with the new software . 3. He has trouble coping with working from home .
of	consist of, accuse (someone) of, remind (someone) of, approve of, dream of, think of, smell of, hear of, inform (someone) of, get rid of, take advantage of.	1. The team consists of five people . 2. He accused her of theft . 3. She dreams of opening her own business .

Preposition	Main verbs	Examples
at	laugh at, look at, shout at, arrive at, stare at, point at, smile at, glance at, aim at, hint at, knock at.	1. Don't laugh at him . 2. We arrived at the airport early. 3. She hinted at changing jobs .

Tips for learning: Record new verbs together with their preposition as one chunk ("apply for", "depend on"). Group them by preposition when revising. Remember that when a verb-ing form comes after a preposition, it is never replaced by the infinitive — *look forward to seeing you*, not *look forward to see you*.